

D317

IT Applications

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A technician at an insurance agency with 25 agents confirms that a PC shows pop-ups and redirects typical of malware. The agent says she only visits trusted sites. The technician has disconnected the PC from the network. What should the technician do next?

- A. Disable System Restore in Windows.
- B. Reconnect the PC, since she only visits trusted sites.
- C. Run a scan with the current definitions without updating.
- D. Educate the user about safe browsing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A technician has removed malware and scheduled scans and updates. Which step comes next?

- A. Disable System Restore.
- B. Quarantine the system.
- C. Enable System Restore and create a new restore point.
- D. Reimage the PC, because malware always returns.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A systems administrator at a regional hospital wants to apply a database patch on Friday evening. The vendor rates it critical, and the admin has installed similar patches many times. According to change management, what must happen before the patch is applied?

- A. Apply it, then document it afterward.
- B. Skip review because the admin is experienced.
- C. Apply it immediately because the vendor rates it critical.
- D. Submit a change request with scope, risk analysis, and a backout plan, and get approval.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A design studio, which stores 900 GB of project files, runs a full backup every Sunday and an incremental backup every other night. The backup drive is in a fireproof safe. The server fails Thursday morning. Which backups are needed to restore?

- A. Wednesday's incremental only.
- B. Sunday's full plus Monday's, Tuesday's, and Wednesday's incrementals.
- C. Sunday's full only.
- D. Sunday's full plus Wednesday's incremental only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company does a full backup on Sunday and a differential every other night. The server fails Friday morning. Which backups are needed?

- A. Sunday's full plus Monday's differential.
- B. Thursday's differential only.
- C. Sunday's full plus every differential Monday through Thursday.
- D. Sunday's full plus Thursday's differential.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A bookkeeper at a firm with 18 staff needs to install a tax-software update twice a year. She has used computers for 20 years. How should her account be set up?

- A. An administrator account because she is experienced.
- B. A guest account.
- C. A standard account, with admin credentials provided through UAC when installs are needed.
- D. A local administrator account for daily use.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A shared folder on a file server in the Phoenix office has share permission Read for Everyone and NTFS permission Full Control for the Sales group. The folder holds 3,000 contracts. What can a Sales member do when accessing it over the network?

- A. Read only
- B. Full Control
- C. Modify
- D. No access

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A file with restricted NTFS permissions is copied from one folder to another folder on the same NTFS volume. What permissions does the copy have?

- A. It gets Full Control for Everyone.
- B. It keeps the stricter of the two sets.
- C. It keeps its original permissions.
- D. It inherits the permissions of the destination folder.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

An employee at a manufacturing plant that runs three shifts gets a phone call from someone claiming to be from the IT help desk, asking for her password to fix a payroll error. The caller knows her manager's name. Which attack is this?

- A. Tailgating
- B. Vishing
- C. Phishing
- D. Smishing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation describes tailgating?

- A. A stranger follows an employee through a badge-controlled door before it closes.
- B. Someone watches an employee type a PIN at a keypad.
- C. An attacker texts a fake delivery link.
- D. An attacker searches the trash for printed passwords.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A Windows 11 PC at a nonprofit with 60 volunteers shows errors that system DLL files are missing or corrupt after a power outage. The PC has a 1 TB SSD with plenty of free space. Which command is designed to repair the system files?

- A.** chkdsk /f
- B.** diskpart to add free space
- C.** sfc /scannow
- D.** gpupdate /force

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A law office of 14 attorneys wants staff to reach the office file server and desktops from home. The office internet plan is 1 Gbps. The managing partner suggests forwarding port 3389 on the router to each desktop. What is the more secure approach?

- A.** Use Telnet instead of RDP for remote work.
- B.** Require a VPN with MFA, then use RDP only inside the tunnel.
- C.** Upgrade to a faster internet plan first.
- D.** Forward 3389 but require strong passwords.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A technician at an insurance agency ~~with 25 agents~~ confirms that a PC shows pop-ups and redirects typical of malware. ~~The agent says she only visits trusted sites.~~ The technician has disconnected the PC from the network. What should the technician do next?

Target word: step after quarantine **Decides:** After quarantine comes disabling System Restore.

A	Correct	Prevents infected restore points from being kept or used during cleanup.
B	Camouflage	Her browsing claim does not change the procedure.
C	Dropped element	Skips disabling System Restore and updating tools first.
D	Inverted operation	Education is the last step.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A technician has removed malware and scheduled scans and updates. Which step comes next?

Target word: step after scheduling scans **Decides:** Re-enable System Restore and create a clean restore point.

A	Confusion set	That was done before remediation.
B	Inverted operation	Quarantine comes early, before remediation.
C	Correct	Now that the system is clean, a safe restore point can be made.
D	Absolute language	A clean removal does not always require a reimage.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A systems administrator at a regional hospital wants to apply a database patch on Friday evening. The vendor rates it critical, ~~and the admin has installed similar patches many times.~~ According to change management, what must happen before the patch is applied?

Target word: change-management prerequisite **Decides:** Changes need documented approval with a backout plan.

A	Inverted operation	Documentation and approval come first.
B	Camouflage	Experience does not replace approval.
C	Absolute language	Critical patches may be expedited but still go through change control.
D	Correct	Approval and a rollback plan come before any production change.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A design studio, ~~which stores 900 GB of project files,~~ runs a full backup every Sunday and an incremental backup every other night. ~~The backup drive is in a fireproof safe.~~ The server fails Thursday morning. Which backups are needed to restore?

Target word: restore set with incrementals **Decides:** Incrementals each hold only one day's changes.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out the full backup.
B	Correct	Every incremental since the last full is needed.
C	Adjacent category	Loses three days of changes.
D	Confusion set	That is the differential rule.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A company does a full backup on Sunday and a differential every other night. The server fails Friday morning. Which backups are needed?

Target word: restore set with differentials **Decides:** Each differential holds all changes since the full.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses the oldest differential, missing later changes.
B	Dropped element	A differential needs its full backup.
C	Inverted operation	Applies the incremental rule to differentials.
D	Correct	The last differential contains every change since Sunday.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A bookkeeper at a firm ~~with 18 staff~~ needs to install a tax-software update twice a year. ~~She has used computers for 20 years.~~ How should her account be set up?

Target word: account type under least privilege **Decides:** Admin rights are needed only occasionally.

A	Camouflage	Experience does not change least privilege.
B	Adjacent category	Too limited for her normal work.
C	Correct	Least privilege: elevate only for the task.
D	Inverted operation	Gives full rights all the time.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A shared folder on a file server ~~in the Phoenix office~~ has share permission Read for Everyone and NTFS permission Full Control for the Sales group. ~~The folder holds 3,000 contracts.~~ What can a Sales member do when accessing it over the network?

Target word: effective network permission **Decides:** Most restrictive of share and NTFS wins over the network.

A	Correct	Share Read is more restrictive than NTFS Full Control.
B	Inverted operation	Takes the most permissive instead of the most restrictive.
C	Adjacent category	Neither permission grants Modify alone here.
D	Confusion set	Both layers allow at least Read.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A file with restricted NTFS permissions is copied from one folder to another folder on the same NTFS volume. What permissions does the copy have?

Target word: permissions after a copy **Decides:** A copy is a new file and inherits the destination's permissions.

A	Absolute language	No default grants Everyone full control.
B	Adjacent category	Applies the share-versus-NTFS rule to a copy.
C	Confusion set	That is the rule for a move within the same volume.
D	Correct	Copying creates a new file that inherits.

9. Answer B Concept 6

An employee at a manufacturing plant ~~that runs three shifts~~ gets a phone call from someone claiming to be from the IT help desk, asking for her password to fix a payroll error. ~~The caller knows her manager's name.~~ Which attack is this?

Target word: identify the attack channel **Decides:** The attack arrives by voice call.

A	Inverted operation	A physical entry attack, not a remote request.
B	Correct	Voice phishing uses phone calls.
C	Adjacent category	Phishing is by email.
D	Confusion set	Smishing is by text message.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

Which situation describes tailgating?

Target word: reverse: match the scenario to the term **Decides:** Tailgating is physically following an authorized person through a secure door.

A	Correct	Entering on someone else's access is tailgating.
B	Confusion set	That is shoulder surfing.
C	Adjacent category	That is smishing.
D	Inverted operation	That is dumpster diving.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A Windows 11 PC at a nonprofit ~~with 60 volunteers~~ shows errors that system DLL files are missing or corrupt after a power outage. ~~The PC has a 1-TB SSD with plenty of free space.~~ Which command is designed to repair the system files?

Target word: tool for corrupt system files **Decides:** Protected Windows system files are corrupt.

A	Confusion set	Repairs file-system errors on the disk, not Windows system files.
B	Camouflage	Free space is not the problem.
C	Correct	System File Checker restores protected system files.
D	Adjacent category	Reapplies Group Policy.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A law office of ~~14 attorneys~~ wants staff to reach the office file server and desktops from home. ~~The office internet plan is 1 Gbps.~~ The managing partner suggests forwarding port 3389 on the router to each desktop. What is the more secure approach?

Target word: secure remote access design **Decides:** Exposing RDP directly to the internet is risky; use an encrypted tunnel.

A	Inverted operation	Telnet sends data in clear text, which is less secure.
B	Correct	The VPN encrypts traffic and keeps RDP off the open internet.
C	Camouflage	Bandwidth does not address security.
D	Dropped element	Still exposes RDP to constant internet attacks.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Malware removal order	Investigate and verify symptoms, quarantine the system, disable System Restore, remediate (update tools, scan and remove), schedule scans and updates, re-enable System Restore and create a restore point, then educate the user.	Leaving System Restore on during cleanup, or skipping quarantine.	"What should the technician do next?" on an infected PC.
2	Change management	A change needs a documented request with purpose, scope, risk analysis, a backout plan, and approval (often by a change advisory board) before implementation.	Making a quick fix in production without approval because it seems small.	A planned update to a live system.
3	Backup types and restore sets	Full backs up everything; incremental backs up changes since the last backup of any kind; differential backs up changes since the last full. Restore = full + every incremental, or full + the last differential.	Thinking a differential restore needs every differential.	A backup schedule and a failure day.
4	Least privilege and UAC	Users should run with standard accounts and elevate only when needed; User Account Control prompts before admin-level changes.	Giving everyone admin rights to reduce help desk tickets.	A user who needs to install one app occasionally.
5	NTFS and share permissions	When accessing over the network, the most restrictive of share and NTFS permissions applies; moving a file within the same NTFS volume keeps its permissions, while copying inherits the destination's.	Taking the most permissive of the two, or thinking copies keep their original permissions.	Share and NTFS permissions both listed, or a file moved versus copied.
6	Social engineering types	Phishing uses email, vishing uses voice calls, smishing uses text messages, tailgating follows someone through a secure door, shoulder surfing watches a screen or keypad.	Calling every scam phishing.	The channel or physical method of the attack.
7	Windows repair commands	sfc /scannow repairs protected system files; chkdsk checks and repairs disk file-system errors; gpupdate /force reapplies Group Policy; ipconfig shows and renews network settings.	Using chkdsk to fix corrupted Windows system files.	A symptom and a choice of command-line tool.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Secure remote access choice	Use a VPN or other encrypted channel for remote access; SSH replaces Telnet for command-line access; do not expose RDP directly to the internet.	Opening RDP to the internet because it has a password.	Staff working remotely need access to internal systems.

Course scope (public description): IT Applications introduces skills in identifying operating systems and their configurations and in implementing security principles across devices and networks. Learners will also gain skills in troubleshooting software, security, and malware issues, and in implementing basic operational procedures in documentation, change management, compliance, and communication. The course will introduce basic disaster recovery and business continuity procedures, scripting basics, and remote access technology solutions. The course prepares learners for the CompTIA A+ Core 2 certification exam.